Peabody

# Thamesmead Newsletter
December 2018

50 1968–2018 Thamesmead

# New chapter for South Thamesmead

You might have noticed that work has begun on the first stage of the development of Southmere Village.

Contractors are preparing the ground for the project that is going to help transform South Thamesmead with a wave of new homes, jobs, shops and other amenities.

These will include: a public lakeside square; a library; community facilities; cafes, shops and a neighbourhood square with play area.

This first phase will provide 130 of the 525 new homes being built in Southmere – ranging from one-bedroom apartments to four-bedroom houses – with around 230 of them being affordable housing.

New jobs will also be created with the introduction of financial and professional services plus commercial spaces.



Matthew Foulis, Peabody's Head of Estate Regeneration for Thamesmead, said:

"It is fantastic that we are now on site delivering much needed homes, shops and services. Some of the homes will provide rehousing opportunities for residents affected by later phases of regeneration meaning we can keep the community together."

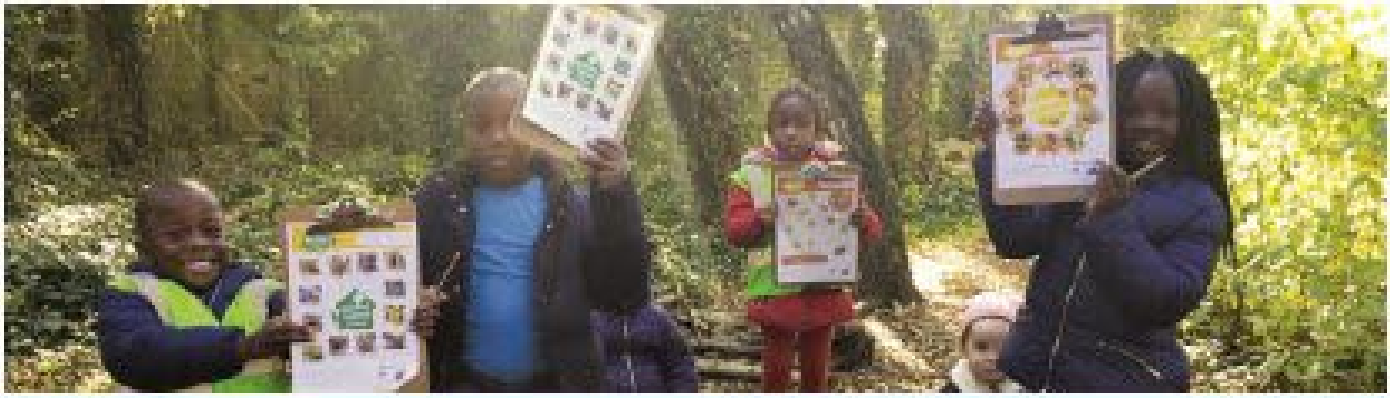
## Back to nature

It's been a busy start to the academic year at Tump 53 Nature Reserve with more than 600 students from schools across Thamesmead enjoying a whole range of activities since the start of September.

Community groups have been using the nature reserve classroom and 100 parents and youngsters came to a Half Term Open Day, hunting toads and newts in the Autumn Scavenger Hunt. A Christmas event will be held on **Thursday 6th December** from **3:00pm to 6:00pm.**

We're also setting up a regular weekly open morning, starting early in 2019 so come along and see for yourself.

For more information, or to arrange a visit, contact **tump53@peabody.org.uk**



## Time for a cha-cha-cha-nge?

Are you over 50? In that case we've got lots of activities across Thamesmead for you, from gentle exercise to lunch clubs and tea dances.

Earlier this year a tea and cabaret afternoon at Lakeview Court proved it's never too late to put on your dancing shoes with nearly 90 people joining in, including a 92-year-old. Transport was provided so residents who aren't normally able to get out got the chance to do just that.

We will be hosting two Christmas events. See the What's on section at **www.thamesmeadnow.co.uk** for details of these and other activities.

## Best foot forward

Local people can now take Thamesmead in their stride after volunteers from: Willow Bank Primary School, Peabody, Charlton Athletic Community Trust and Royal Borough of Greenwich attended a Walk Leader course by Bexley Walking for Health Coordinator, Helen Sadique.

This training has helped to create three new guided walks round Thamesmead due to start in January, which all include one of the health centres (Gallions, West Thamesmead and Lakeside) on the route.

Walking is a great way to get fit, engage with the community and see the scenic parts of Thamesmead. Go to **www.thamesmeadnow.co.uk** for more details.

# Virtual reality helps transform Claridge Way



Residents are being trained in how to use the very latest Virtual Reality (VR) and 3D technology as part of an innovative £300,000 project to transform Claridge Way in The Moorings.

Claridge Way – Ideas into Action was launched in October with a tea party event where local people shared their ideas and got to view a 360-degree film of the area made by residents in collaboration with digital design partners Habs3D.

This was followed by three workshops where residents got to don immersive VR headsets and explore a 3D digital model of Claridge Way, adding virtual objects, such as planters and benches, to generate ideas for when the work is carried out next year.

Resident Fatima Jagne said: "I really enjoyed the workshop and would like to develop my skills further next time. The workshop helped me find out more about VR and think about the industry I would like to join when I'm older."

For all the latest on the project go to **www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk/claridgeway.**

# Mums on the run

Mum Michelle turned September's Thamesmead 5K run into a real family affair by running with daughter Lauren. Michelle said: "I love that I was a role model for my daughter to compete in an event she's never done before and I never thought she would."




You could join Michelle and be part of an Active Thamesmead! by joining Thamesmead Running Club on Saturdays at 8.45am, starting on 19th January. Over 12 weeks we will gradually build you up to get from couch to 5km. No fitness required, just willingness! Contact Stephanie Turner on **020 3828 4925** or **Stephanie.Turner@peabody.org.uk** to get The New Year off on the right foot!

## Lend a helping hand

Why not register to become a volunteer in Thamesmead? It'll give you a real sense of personal satisfaction as well as the opportunity to develop your skills and experience while helping others.

We've got a wide range of opportunities available and it's never been easier to get involved.

If you're interested visit My Story at **www.thamesmeadnow.co.uk** to be inspired by our current volunteers or contact Symone Brown at **Symone.Brown@peabody.org.uk** or 0203 828 3601.

# Portal to success

Thamesmead residents can find employment and training opportunities, business guidance, funding advice and community activities all in one place, with the launch of the new Thamesmead Portal.

Going live in December and accessible through the Thamesmead Now website (**www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk**) the Thamesmead Portal brings together everything you need to look for a job, learn new skills, start your own business or volunteer locally. It is easy to use, you can even go online to create your own profile, as well as seeing what opportunities are available from local and national employers.



## New BAME Network launches

More than 20 people took part in the launch of the BAME (Black Asian and Minority Ethnic) Network in October, created for BAME community groups in Bexley to come together, collaborate, highlight issues and share solutions.

The next meeting will take place in early 2019. If you've interested in taking part contact **Rachel Akindele** at **rachel@bvsc.co.uk** or **07951 993 234.**



Photo credit: Rhoda Akindele

## Football course scores big

Sporting Club Thamesmead played host to a successful week-long football event for local youngsters during the October half-term. The course proved very popular and was full to capacity with an average of more than 40 future would-be Raheem Sterlings being put through their paces every day.

The sessions provided an opportunity for children aged 5 to 12 years-old to play matches and tournaments as well as tightening up their technique and learning new skills. The Club will be running similar sessions in the February half-term so keep your eye on **www.thamesmeadnow.co.uk** for more details.

## Foodies on the menu

Do you run a food business or are thinking of starting one? If the answer is "Yes" we'd love to hear from you.

There's a number of initiatives being developed to support local people looking to set up, develop and grow their own food businesses, from FREE opportunities to sell your products or trial a food idea to help with issues like training and sourcing permits.

It's all part of our plans to support and encourage a thriving community of foodie entrepreneurs in Thamesmead.

If you want to participate send your details to **madeinthamesmead@peabody.org.uk**

## No childcare? No problem

Residents with young children are learning new skills at the Discovery Children's Centre on Battery Road, West Thamesmead, thanks to a new 14-week Level 2 Teaching Assistant Training programme.

There's a mobile crèche on site so parents don't have to worry about childcare while they're taking part. The training has been organised by Peabody in partnership with HCT Group and GLL East Children's Centres. It was designed to provide a qualification that can lead into flexible work for residents who have childcare demands.

If you would like to hear more about other events please contact **ChildcareTeam@peabody.org.uk**

# POP UP MARKET

2018

Christmas Market

Friday 7 December The Link

2019

Friday 11 January Information Hub

Friday 8 February The Link

Friday 8 March Information Hub

Friday 5 April The Link

Thamesmead Information Hub Unit 214, Yarnton Way, DA18 4DR
The Link Bazalgette Way, SE2 9AN
Contact madeinthamesmead@peabody.org.uk




# THAMESMEAD BUSINESS FORUM

**Meetings held 4pm-6pm**
**First Monday of every month**

**2018**
3 December Information Hub

**2019**
7 January 4 The Link
February 4 The Link
March The Link

- Support
- Mentoring
- Training
- Tender Opportunities
- News
- Events
- Pop-Up Markets

**Find out how your business can access the potential growth opportunities in Thamesmead.**

**Open to all individuals, Start-up's or established businesses looking to start, develop or grow in Thamesmead.**

Thamesmead Information Hub **Unit 214, Yarnton Way, DA18 4DR**
The Link **Bazalgette Way, SE2 9AN**
Contact **madeinthamesmead@peabody.org.uk**

Thamesmead Peabody

Made in Thamesmead

50 Thamesmead

# South Thamesmead

## Wolvercote Towers

The Wolvercote Road Towers will be comprehensively redeveloped in the years ahead as part of our regeneration strategy. In the meantime, residents are still going to see their homes receive a major upgrade thanks to a new improvement scheme.

Contractors Vinci and Durkan will be carrying out work on Wolvercote Road and Park View Towers respectively that will make homes there warmer, cheaper to heat and more pleasant to live in.

The improvements include replacing the old single-glazed windows with new double-glazed UPVC ones, installing new extractor fans and external concrete repairs, all at no cost to residents. Work will begin in the New Year and is due to be completed by Winter 2019.

## Binsey Walk

In an important step in the regeneration of South Thamesmead the last few remaining properties on Binsey Walk and Coralline Walk have now been transferred to Peabody.

Binsey Walk will be demolished in 2019 to prepare the site for redevelopment. The site will deliver around 329 new homes, some of which will rehouse Wolvercote Road residents, meaning further phases of regeneration in the area can move forward.

## High price of littering

The Peabody Warden Team can now issue fines of £75 to anyone caught littering after being given new powers by the Royal Borough of Greenwich to respond to low level environmental crime. For fly-tipping the Fixed Penalty Notice rises to £400.

The Warden Team can also issue Community Protection Notices which compel occupiers to make changes to their premises if they are causing problems for other residents. It is a criminal offence to fail to comply with these Notices with prosecution assessed by Royal Borough of Greenwich.



# Back to the future

The Thamesmead Community Archive has been launched and we're looking for your memories, photos and documents that capture the last 50 years of life in Thamesmead.

Come and join us on 1st December from 11-4pm at the Information Hub, 216 Yarnton Way, where we'll be ready to scan your photos and record your stories over a cup of tea.

Additionally, if you'd like to get even more involved in this important project please get in touch with **Lisa.Drew@peabody.org.uk.**

Volunteers need to be available for a minimum of 50 days between January to June 2019 and will receive special oral history training from the British Library, as well as scanning and logging tuition.

## TM on TV

Did you spot Thamesmead on BBC's recent thriller 'Informer'? Set on a fictional London estate the six-part series explored the work of Counter-terrorism officers and informants.

Many scenes were filmed around Thamesmead with more than 20 local people working on the production as runners or extras.

We're working with agency Filmfixer to manage all TV & movie production in the town and get Thamesmead residents involved in the filming that's happening on their doorsteps.

If you're interested in taking part contact **Lisa.Drew@peabody.org.uk.**



# What's on December and January

**Please visit**
**www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk**
**for the full list of events.**

**Keep Fit for Older Adults – Jubilee**
**Tuesdays 11.30am-12.30pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Jubilee Community Centre, Lytton Strachey Path, Thamesmead, SE28 8DY
Gentle exercise to keep fit, open to anyone aged 50+.
**Contact:** Stephanie Turner – 020 3828 4925 or **Stephanie.Turner@peabody.org.uk**

**Feel Good at The Atrium**
**Wednesdays 11.00am-2.00pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Teeswater Court, Middle Way, DA18 4DG
A drop-in session for anyone aged 50+. A place to make new friends and join in activities such as gentle exercises, bingo and much more.
**Contact:** Kim Firmin, **kim@listeningear.org**

**Pop in Parlour**
**Wednesdays & Fridays**
**11.00am-1.00pm**
**Cost:** Low cost
**Venue:** Lakeview Court, Central Way, Thamesmead, SE28 8GL
Group for the over 60's offering quizzes, bingo and coach trips away. Enjoy freshly cooked meals and a cup of tea/coffee amongst a group of friendly faces.
**Contact:** Daniel Browne, 0203 828 3888

**Keep Fit for Older Adults – Atrium**
**Fridays 11.00am-12.00pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Atrium Community Centre, Teeswater Court, Mangold Way, Erith, DA18 4DG
Gentle exercise to keep fit, open to anyone aged 50+.
**Contact:** Stephanie Turner – 020 3828 4925 or **Stephanie.Turner@peabody.org.uk**

**Seated Pilates**
**Fridays, 11.30am-12.30pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Lakeview Court, Central Way, Thamesmead, SE28 8GL
Chair-based Pilates for those who have limited mobility. Open to anyone aged 50+.
**Contact:** Stephanie Turner – 020 3828 4925. **Stephanie.Turner@peabody.org.uk**

**Strictly Fun Dancing**
**1st Sunday of the month, 2.00pm-4.00pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Lakeview Court, Central Way, Thamesmead, SE28 8GL
Dancing and socialising for older people aged 50+ for all abilities. No partner needed.
**Contact:** Rachel Sparks, 07875 001 931

**Make Thamesmead Sparkle**
Christmas event and lights on in Thamesmead Town Centre, Joyce Dawson Way
**Friday 30th November**
**4.00pm-7.00pm**
Peabody are working in partnership with the Royal Borough of Greenwich and Berkeley Homes, to put on the "Make Thamesmead Sparkle" Christmas Light's On Event
This is a free event being held at the Clock Tower in Thamesmead Town Centre. The Christmas Lights will be officially turned on to start the countdown to Christmas in Thamesmead! There will be a number of local businesses selling a variety of food and Christmas gifts, local artists and musicians will be singing and performing and they'll be Arts and Crafts fun for the children too.

**Over 50's Festive Fun Event**
**Tuesday 11th December**
**12.00pm-4.00pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Lakeview Court, Central Way, Thamesmead, SE28 8GL
Come along for an afternoon of Christmas classics, mince pies and lots of festive fun. Transport available however, spaces are limited – call or email to book.
**Contact:** Georgia Mann, 020 3828 3948 or **Georgia.mann@peabody.org.uk**

**Moorings Dinner and Dance**
**Sunday 16th December**
**2.00pm-7.00pm**
**Cost:** Free
**Venue:** Hawksmoor Youth Club, Bentham Road, SE28 8AS
The Moorings Residents Community Group will be running a Community Dinner and Dance for local elderly and isolated individuals, supported by the Peabody 50th Fund and Young Greenwich. This event is free but places are limited. If you have an elderly neighbour who could benefit from this please contact Penny on 07400 353 315, Lisa on 07930 338 571 or Hawksmoor Youth Club on 020 8310 9754 to discuss.

**Culture Forum**
**Monday 17th December**
**5.00pm - 7.00pm** (and every third Monday of the month)
A place to discover and connect what is already happening in the area, and to make collective plans. Everyone welcome, come and join us for our Christmas meeting in December. Please e-mail **Lisa.Drew@peabody.org.uk** for more details and to be put on the mailing list.

## Contact us

**Online**
**www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk**
**Email**
**thamesmead.regen@peabody.org.uk**
**Phone**
**0300 123 1237**

**Visit us**
The Information Hub
216 Yarnton Way, DA18 4AX
Open from 11am - 4pm every Tuesday and Wednesday and the first Saturday of every month

**Find out what's happening across Thamesmead**
Sign up to the Thamesmead e-newsletter. All you have to do is email **thamesmeadnow@peabody.org.uk** adding 'Sign me up' in the subject line.

**www.thamesmeadnow.org.uk**
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**ThamesmeadLDN**

LONDON BOROUGH OF BEXLEY
ROYAL Borough of GREENWICH